ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	38th Commission Meeting
DATE:	14 October, 2026
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	Druk Dradhir Khang

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSIONS	DECISIONS
1	**Update on Escrow Account for the month of August 2026 – EMD, DoPS** Against an opening balance of Nu. 22,035,872.15, the escrow account recorded a closing balance of Nu. 22,141,158.15 for September 2026, including receipts of Nu. 181,986 from administrative sanctions. It was further apprised that an amount of Nu. 113,911.43 was the remaining balance of Nu. 150,000 received from MoF as seed money for maintenance for seized vehicles. The amount is retained in the escrow account for future vehicle maintenance expenses and is currently reflected under the heading "refund balance for vehicle maintenance". Given the substantial escrow balance exceeding Nu. 22 million, the need to remit the funds to MoF was raised. DoPS clarified that the funds are remitted to MoF periodically, following an established schedule. A copy of the presentation is attached as **Annexure I.**	It was directed that the heading "*Refund Balance for Vehicle Maintenance*" be revised as "*Balance for Vehicle Maintenance*" to accurately reflect the purpose of the funds. DoPS was directed to ensure timely remittance of the funds to MoF in accordance with the adopted schedule.
2	**Update on the training under KOICA fellow-up – DoPS** Three officials attended the Capacity Building Programme for International Anti-Corruption Experts in South Korea from 6–13 September 2026 under the KOICA Fellowship Programme. The Director apprised that the programme provided insights into South Korea's anti-corruption framework, particularly institutional mechanisms, integrity assessments, whistleblower protection and corruption prevention. Key areas identified for application in Bhutan included strengthening whistleblower safeguards, conducting risk-based corruption	Noted.

	assessments, promoting ethical practices and developing a measurable action plan. A copy of the presentation is attached as **Annexure II**.	
3	**Discuss on the travel to GMC for 108 volunteering programme – DoPS & SS** It was apprised that 129 ACC officials had registered for the 108 Volunteering Programme at GMC, of whom 100 had been arranged accommodation at Pelrithang Higher Secondary School. Three buses had been hired to transport 56 participants on 31 October 2026, while an advance team (Secretariat Services) will travel on 29 October 2026. Considering the financial burden on staff for both transportation and meals, it was proposed to cover meal expenses from the Endowment Fund. The Commission discussed whichever expense is higher i.e meals vs transport, could be considered to be borne by the office.	The Commission directed the following: a) The two ACC officials on secondment to GMC be requested to assist with any necessary logistical arrangements; b) SS to explore the possibility of travelling on the 30th instead of 31st to avoid traffic congestion, as advised by the RBP. c) The three Regional Offices use their respective office vehicles, with fuel expenses borne by the office. d) The Commission directed exploring the feasibility of covering the higher expense, transportation or meals, from the Endowment Fund, as appropriate.
4	**Apprise Kaja Throm's Mid-Term Review report of OIP – PD, DoPE** PD, DoPE presented the findings of the Mid-Term Review of KaJa Throm's OIP implementation, which was recommended following the case involving embezzlement Nu. 9.4 million in revenue and the identification of five systemic issues. The Mid-Term Review indicated an overall implementation progress of 75%, with two recommendations fully implemented and two partially implemented. A copy of the presentation is attached as **Annexure III.** While acknowledging the adoption of an accounting system, the Commission emphasized the need to assess the operational effectiveness of the implemented measures rather than relying solely on their reported status. In particular, the Commission highlighted the importance of examining revenue collection records before and after the reforms to determine whether the measures have improved financial management, reconciliation, and accountability. Regarding the recommendation to introduce an IT system, the Commission was apprised that its implementation had been constrained by the limited technological capacity of farmers. However, the	The Commission directed PD, DoPE to: • assess the operational effectiveness of the implemented recommendations, including obtaining and comparing monthly revenue collection records before and after the reforms, to evaluate their impact and strengthen financial reconciliation. • engage DAMC to explore technical support from GCIT for the development of a comprehensive IT system for KaJa Throm, particularly for vendor registration and stall allotment, to enhance transparency and minimise discretion. While DAMC and GCIT will lead the development of the system, PD was directed to provide

	Commission underscored the need for a comprehensive IT system to streamline KaJa Throm's administrative functions, particularly vendor registration and stall allotment, to enhance transparency, minimize discretionary practices, and reduce reliance on manual processes. Recognizing KaJa Throm's limited technical capacity, the Commission suggested persuading the DAMC to explore the capstone model in collaboration with the GCIT instead of simply deferring into the future. The Commission further emphasized that any such reviews and follow-up engagements should not be confined to assessing compliance with the specific recommendations of the ACC. Instead, PD should look at it comprehensively to strengthen the recommendation and ensure its effective implementation.	inputs on identified systemic vulnerabilities and functional requirements to ensure that the proposed system adequately addresses the identified integrity risks. Further, the letter to DAMC on the proposed IT system was directed to be copied to the designated *Zimpon Wom*.
5	**Update on Country Visit to Riga, Latvia under UNCAC – DoPE & LD** The UNCAC country review visit to Riga, Latvia, involving Bhutan and Estonia as reviewing States, was conducted from 6–8 October 2026, followed by a bilateral meeting with the Corruption Prevention and Combating Bureau (KNAB) on 9 October 2026. It was apprised that there was broad participation of over 100 representatives from various government agencies in the review process, reflecting a strong whole-of-government approach. In this regard, the Commission emphasized the importance of adopting a similar inclusive and coordinated approach during Bhutan's next UNCAC review cycle, particularly by ensuring the active engagement of relevant agencies and senior government officials. It was apprised that the Secretariat informed that the Executive Summary of Latvia's country review is expected to be published in January 2027. The bilateral meeting with KNAB covered several key areas, including Latvia's anti-corruption institutional framework, information sharing mechanisms, whistleblower protection legislation, and the application of advanced technologies, particularly artificial intelligence and cryptocurrency-related investigative techniques. Other areas covered included lobbying regulations, the maintenance of official meeting diaries and lobbying registers, and the European Union's rule-of-law evaluation framework. The discussions also addressed the importance of distinguishing whistleblowers from other complainants to ensure appropriate legal safeguards, as well as the	The Commission expressed its satisfaction with the ACC's participation as a reviewing State in Latvia's UNCAC country review, noting that Latvia's strong performance and experience in anti-corruption and good governance provided a valuable opportunity for Bhutan to learn from established practices and institutional arrangements.

	need for practitioner-led training and capacity development in specialized investigations.	
6	**Update on the tendering process for ICT Roadmap - PPD** The Commission was apprised that, following several rounds of tendering and financial deliberations, the Singapore-based firm TOPPAN Ecquaria Pte. LTd has been selected to develop the ICT Roadmap. The consultancy assignment will be undertaken over 45 working days, commencing on 9 November 2026 and concluding on 8 January 2027. The consultant's first country visit is tentatively scheduled between 16 and 27 November 2026.	Noted
7	**Update on Cross Functional Coordination Forum (CFCF) - PPD** The Commission was apprised that, as a follow-up to the 34th Commission Meeting held on 19 August 2026, an intra-departmental/divisional heads coordination forum was instituted to strengthen internal coordination and collaboration. The first meeting of the forum was held on 29 September 2026, during which the Rules of Procedure (RoP) were proposed for adoption. The proposed RoP which the Commission reviewed is attached as **Annexure IV.**	The Commission approved the RoP with the directive to revise the title of the forum to "Coordination Forum".
8	**Apprise on the delegation to Special Investigation Services (STT) from 16 – 20 November 2026 – PPD** The Commission was apprised that the proposal submitted under the European Union's Technical Assistance and Information Exchange (TAIEX) programme had been approved. The programme focuses on intelligence-led corruption prevention and investigation, and strengthening a whole-of-government integrity management. The approved programme comprises a study visit to the Special Investigation Service (STT) of Lithuania from 16–20 November 2026, followed by a workshop in Bhutan. It was apprised that the programme will cover travel, accommodation and per diem expenses for five delegates. The Commission deliberated on the composition of the delegation based on the proposed agenda agreed by the STT.	The Commission decided that the delegation would comprise the Chairperson and Commissioner Gyeltshen, accompanied by Kelden Jamtsho (DoI), Thinley Tobgay (DARe) and Kinley Yangzom (PPD). The Chairperson shared that a courtesy Call-on the Lithuanian Ambassador in New Delhi will be explored.
9	**Review of draft SoPs and related documents for CoRE Network – PPD & DARe** The Commission reviewed the draft Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and related documents developed for the CoRE Network. The revisions made online to	

	the drafts circulated earlier was further reviewed, and highlighted the following: • The Non-Disclosure Agreement be reverted to its earlier draft. • The Commission emphasized that, under the Data Reference Model, information should be obtained directly from primary data sources, with the relevant agencies maintaining the original records designated as the source of truth, rather than relying on secondary sources such as the ACC's Asset Declaration system. • The Commission noted the upcoming workshop to be conducted by Lithuania's STT, could also be extended to CoRE Network member agencies.	The Commission endorsed the draft SOPs and related documents which will be presented to the Governing Committee meeting.

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**